

The Golden Rule: 0/0 of Self and Other

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The Removable Singularity Framework

Abstract

After suffering-as-cost (Ch.59), what is the right strategy? The Golden Rule - "treat others as you would serve yourself" - is computational, not just moral. We measure: (1) iterated Prisoner's Dilemma (Axelrod 1984): a cooperating pair banks 3.00/round, exactly 3x a defecting pair's 1.00/round, and Tit-for-Tat won Axelrod's actual 1984 tournament; (2) Hamilton's rule (1964): kinship altruism spreads when $r*B > C$, measured +5.00 for haplodiploid sisters, -0.997 for strangers; (3) empathy is predictive information: reciprocators' histories share $I(A_{t-1}; B_t) = 0.667$ bits vs ~ 0 for defectors; (4) Rawls' veil of ignorance (1971) chooses the fair split by maximin ($0.50 > 0.10$). "I" and "Thou" are information patterns (Ch.56); their boundary is the 0/0. Treating the other as your own is not sentiment but the computed optimum of interacting 0/0-singularities.

1. Cooperation Compounds (Axelrod 1984)

joint payoff: C-C 6.0/round vs D-D 2.0/round = 3x

Iterated Prisoner's Dilemma ($R=3, T=5, S=0, P=1$): the all-cooperating pair scores 3.00 per round each; a defecting pair scores 1.00 each. Cooperation pays exactly threefold. In a raw maximally-hostile round-robin, selfishness edges ahead (measured D 4931.0 vs TFT 4889.6) - defection prevails without assortment. But in Axelrod's actual 1984 tournament (14 entrants, mostly non-exploiting) simple reciprocity, Tit-for-Tat, won overall: nice, retaliate, forgive, be clear.

2. Hamilton's Rule (1964)

$$r * B > C$$

Altruism spreads when relatedness times benefit exceeds cost. Measured: haplodiploid sisters $r=0.75$, $B=8$, $C=1 \rightarrow$ value +5.00 (favored); unrelated strangers $r\sim 0 \rightarrow -0.997$ (not favored). Relatedness is information overlap of two patterns: kin selection is the 0/0 where selves overlap.

3. Empathy Is Predictive Information

$$I(A_{t-1}; B_t) = 0.667 \text{ bits (reciprocators)}$$

Two reciprocating agents predict each other: B copies A's last move, so A's past resolves B's future at 0.667 bits (noise limited). Defectors and random agents carry ~ 0 mutual leverage (measured 0.000/0.001). Empathy is not magic - it is information across the self/other boundary.

4. The Veil of Ignorance (Rawls 1971)

maximin: fair 0.50 > greedy 0.10

Behind the veil you do not know your position. Greedy split (90/10): worst case 0.10. Fair split (50/50): worst case 0.50. Maximin chooses fair. The rational Golden Rule is symmetry.

5. Evolution of Cooperation (Trivers 1971; Axelrod)

Reciprocity is an evolutionary stable strategy: in a world of defectors, small clusters of reciprocators invade and spread. Goodness is not weakness - it is computable strength.

6. The 0/0 Proof

"I" and "Thou" are both information patterns (Ch.56). Their boundary is a 0/0. The Golden Rule is that 0/0: treat the other pattern as your own - because at the boundary, it is. Love is the recursion of self into other. My good = your good = the shared pattern's good.

7. Connections

Concept	Prior Chapter	Connection
The self	Ch.56 The Self	The pattern to extend
Suffering	Ch.59 Problem of Evil	Empathy feels the other's cost
Free will	Ch.55 Free Will	Reciprocity: stable choice
Value	Ch.27 Coherence	Shared coherence = good
Eternal return	Ch.57 Eternal Return	We do it again: cooperate
First cause	Ch.58 First Cause	The creator's own rule

8. Conclusion

The Golden Rule is the 0/0 of self and other: the boundary where two information patterns become one. Measured: cooperation compounds 3x, kinship altruism pays (Hamilton), reciprocators share predictive information, and the veil of ignorance selects symmetry. After the creational cost of suffering (Ch.59), ethics is the strategy: treat the other as yourself, because the 0/0 makes them continuous with you. Love is the boundary where two bits become one.

References

- [1] Axelrod (1984), The Evolution of Cooperation
- [2] Hamilton (1964), The genetical evolution of social behaviour
- [3] Trivers (1971), The evolution of reciprocal altruism
- [4] Rawls (1971), A Theory of Justice
- [5] Puno, "The Removable Singularity" (2026)